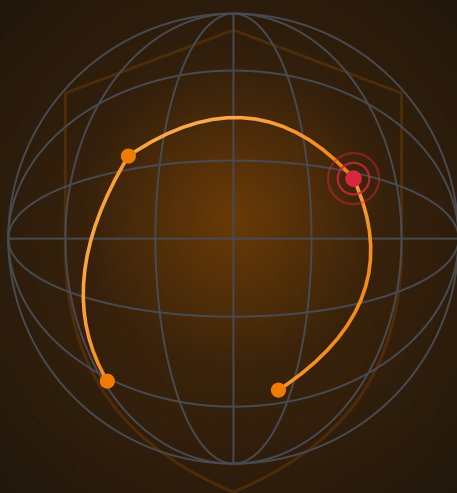




THREAT PULSE

WEEKLY CYBER THREAT BRIEFING

WEEK IN REVIEW · 10–16 AUGUST 2026

Inside this week: a **critical flaw in a common network appliance** under active attack, Microsoft's big August update that **fixes a Windows flaw already used in attacks**, and a **self-spreading "worm"** loose in the open-source software world — explained in plain English, with the practical steps that matter.

Welcome to **Threat Pulse**, your plain-English weekly round-up of the cyber threats making waves around the world — and what they mean for your business. This week a **critical, already-exploited flaw in a widely used network appliance** topped the list, Microsoft's monthly update **fixed a Windows weakness attackers were already abusing**, and a **self-spreading “worm” hit the open-source software supply chain**. No jargon, just what happened and the practical steps worth taking.

AT A GLANCE THIS WEEK

 **9.6** /10

Severity of the Progress LoadMaster flaw now under active attack worldwide

 **400** +

Flaws fixed in Microsoft's August update, including a Windows zero-day already used in attacks

 **1,700** +

Software-package versions poisoned by a self-spreading “worm”

THIS WEEK'S HEADLINE THREAT

PROGRESS KEMP LOADMASTER • CVE-2026-8037

A critical flaw in a common network appliance is being exploited to hijack company systems



CRITICAL

Exploitation: **active & in the wild**

WHAT'S HAPPENING

A serious weakness in **Progress Kemp LoadMaster** — a widely used “load balancer” that keeps busy websites and business apps online — lets attackers run their own commands on the device **without needing any password**. After example attack code was posted publicly, criminals began exploiting it, and the US cyber agency CISA added it to its **actively-exploited list**, giving federal bodies just three days to patch. Because these devices sit at the edge of the network, a break-in gives attackers a powerful foothold.

WHO'S AFFECTED

Any organisation running **Progress Kemp LoadMaster** (GA 7.2.63.1 or older, or LTSF 7.2.54.17 or older) — and some related Progress products such as ECS Connection Manager and MOVEit WAF. These appliances are common in data centres and larger business networks, where they share traffic across servers to keep services fast and reliable.

WHY IT MATTERS TO YOU

Because these appliances sit at the edge with a clear view of internal services, a break-in here can expose **internal systems and credentials** and hand attackers a lasting foothold across your network — the sort of access that leads to data theft or ransomware.

Good news if you don't run LoadMaster: many smaller and cloud-only businesses don't use this appliance, so they aren't directly exposed. It's still worth a quick check with your IT provider or hosting company, who may use it behind the scenes.

What to do about the headline threat

-  Ask your IT team or provider whether any **Progress Kemp LoadMaster** (or ECS Connection Manager / MOVEit WAF) appliances are in use, and if so, confirm they're updated to the **latest fixed version**.
-  Because the flaw is being **actively exploited**, treat it as urgent — patch now, or take the appliance off the public internet until it's fixed.
-  Ask them to **check the appliance's logs** for signs of tampering — patching alone won't undo a break-in that already happened.

 OTHER THREATS WORTH KNOWING ABOUT

HIGH

Microsoft's August update fixes a flaw already under attack

Microsoft's monthly "Patch Tuesday" (11 August) fixed **more than 400 security flaws**, including a Windows weakness (CVE-2026-68820) that attackers — reportedly a North Korean group — were **already exploiting** to seize full control of machines they'd gained a foothold on. Several other fixes address serious flaws that could spread on their own.

Takeaway: make sure August's Windows and Microsoft updates are installed across every device — desktops, laptops and servers.



HIGH

A self-spreading "worm" hits open-source software

A worm nicknamed "**Shai-Hulud**" hijacked hundreds of popular open-source software components (including the widely used **keyv** library) on the npm registry, poisoning 1,700+ versions. It **steals developer and cloud passwords and keys** and uses them to infect yet more components automatically. Because almost all modern software is built on these shared building blocks, the risk ripples outward.

Takeaway: if you build or commission software, ask your developers and suppliers whether they were affected and to rotate any exposed passwords, tokens and keys.



MEDIUM

One logistics breach, many big brands' customers exposed

A breach at global logistics firm **Ceva Logistics** exposed customer contact details tied to a string of well-known companies — including retailers, a bank and a football club. It's a reminder that your information sits with the **third parties** you and your suppliers rely on.

Takeaway: know which outside companies hold your and your customers' data, and ask how they'd notify you if they were breached.

 Your 3-minute checklist this week

-  Confirm any **LoadMaster / edge appliances** are patched to the latest version and not needlessly exposed to the internet (see previous page).
-  Install **August's Windows and Microsoft updates** on every device — including servers.
-  If you develop or commission software, ask your team or suppliers to **check for the npm worm** and rotate exposed credentials.
-  Remind staff to **pause and verify** any unexpected request for money, log-ins or data.

Threat Pulse is provided by DPG-Cyber for general awareness only and does not constitute specific security or legal advice. Threat details are drawn from reputable public reporting as at 17 August 2026 and may evolve as investigations continue. For guidance tailored to your environment, please contact your DPG-Cyber account team.

BEHIND THE HEADLINES

Why a **watchful eye** changes the outcome

Every threat in this issue had one thing in common: the damage happened in the **quiet gap between the break-in and the moment someone noticed**. Tools alone rarely stop an attack — what limits the harm is continuous monitoring that correlates the signals, spots the intrusion early, and responds before a foothold becomes a crisis.

247 days

Average time for organisations to identify *and* contain a breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2026

\$4.99M

Global average total cost of a single data breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2026

THE WINDOW THAT MATTERS

Intrusion
the way in

Foothold
quietly settling in

Lateral movement
spreading across systems

Impact
data theft / ransomware

↑ The sooner an attack is spotted, the smaller the damage. Closing this window — detecting and responding on the left, long before impact on the right — is the entire job of a Security Operations Centre.

WHAT CONTINUOUS MONITORING QUIETLY DOES



Sees across everything

A SIEM gathers and correlates activity from across your systems, so unusual behaviour stands out instead of hiding in the noise.



Watches around the clock

Attacks don't keep office hours. A SOC means real people monitoring day, night and weekends — not just 9 to 5.



Knows the latest tactics

Fresh threat intelligence — like the appliance and supply-chain attacks in this issue — feeds detection so new tricks are recognised fast.



Acts, not just alerts

Alerts are triaged and investigated by analysts who step in early, turning a would-be incident into a non-event.

CLIENT ACTION OF THE WEEK

THIS WEEK'S FIX

Install this month's Microsoft updates

Microsoft's **August updates** fix a Windows flaw already being used in real attacks, plus several that could spread on their own. Ask your IT team to confirm they're applied across **every device** — desktops, laptops and servers — this week.

GOOD HABIT

Review who has admin access

Every quarter, list every account with **administrator or privileged access** and remove any no longer needed. Fewer admin accounts means fewer keys for an attacker to steal — often the difference between a minor incident and a full takeover.

This is the quiet, everyday work behind **DPG-Cyber's SIEM & SOC services** — the same monitoring and response that turns headlines like these into non-events for the businesses we look after. If you're ever curious how it would map to your own environment, we're always happy to talk it through, no pressure — just drop us a line at hello@dpg-cyber.com.